

Eternal Vacation

Someone out there recently got an automated response after reporting a phishing attempt to HSBC. It contained the line "I will be out of the office starting 05/10/2006 and will not return until 17/07/2050." A 44-year vacation? No wonder bank jobs are so much in demand!

HSBC

They Prefer Their Apples Green...

Five months ago, Greenpeace said Apple was the least "green" of the major tech companies, grading their use of toxic chemicals in products. They're now *again* giving Apple the bad report card! Talk about reminders—and about cutting some slack!



Escape

MAN-HACKS?

Virtual Newsroom Attacked By Flying Penises

Daniel Sadville, a CNET reporter who is famous for hyping *Second Life*, the online virtual world that's the rage now, was recently trying to interview one of the virtual millionaires when they were attacked by giant flying penises! All this happened in the virtual world of *Second Life*, of course, which explains how it was possible for them to be attacked by the animated appendages.

The interview was being conducted in CNET's office within the popular virtual world, and Sadville was trying to get virtual millionaire Ailin Graef to share her secrets of setting up and successfully running businesses in *Second Life*. Then the attack happened—animated flying penises flew at the virtual CNET building for about 15 minutes. Obviously, the interview was halted immediately, and

Graef refused to continue. She then agreed to do so, providing the location was shifted to her own private space. Didn't help though, because as soon as the interview was restarted, the obscene appendages returned. In fact the hacker seemed to have been following Graef, because he then managed to crash the server on which Graef's space was hosted.

Perseverance paid off though, and after restarting the server, the interview continued normally without further incident. Looks like it's not just real-life anchors and news reporters who suffer from bloopers or intrusions! If people continue to take *Second Life* as seriously as they are right now, we're going to need a lot more security online—as much as we have offline, it seems.

However, what we must

wonder about is, how some people can take a world like *Second Life* more seriously than their real lives? When was the last time you saw members of a terrorist organisation attack with... well... their... err... members? Whatever the case, watch this space for more unbelievable nonsense from the world of *Second Life*. We shudder to think, "What next?"

CHRISTMAS CHAOS

Seller Beware?

December seemed to be the month of e-commerce boo-boos for UK-based retailers. First it was retail outlet Woolworths' online store that was offering *all* sizes of LCD TVs for just £150 (about

Whatever Happened To...

Horizontal PC Cabinets?

Surely you remember the time when the average PC consisted of a monitor perched atop the cabinet. The design had been around for ages, and nobody messed with it—not until the coming of the Tower, anyway. Since then, the picture of the PC itself changed, and the monitor-tower-everything else setup has become staple, but what of our horizontal friends?

A horizontal cabinet occupies a little more space than your monitor, so it's not a space hog if you use it with the monitor on top. Any airflow considerations you'd have to make would apply no matter which way your cabinet is oriented, so that couldn't have been a factor in its fadeout. We aren't saying they're *totally* history—you'll find them being peddled as cabinets for Home Theatre PCs, small form-factor PCs, and other applications where compactness and prettiness matter more than core functionality. But towers have their advantages—they occupy the same area irrespective of height, so you can stack them with more hardware.

The horizontal cabinet's fall from top spot *could* have something to do with the fact that monitors became bigger before cabinets could get stronger. Or that they raise the monitor to a height that qualifies as an ergonomic no-no. Maybe they just weren't cool enough. Got any theories? Write to us and put in your own two cents (91 paise)!

Win! My Desktop

Last month's winner is **Vaibhav Sharma**, Gorakhpur (UP)

We're invariably content with still desktops, but Vaibhav Sharma's Flash escapades have made us think different. Sadly, we can't show you how it animates. He used:

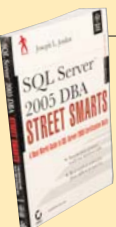
1. Macromedia Flash 8 to design the background and publish to HTML. There are navigation buttons to view the next or previous wallpaper
 2. ObjectDock, 3. CrystalXP
- Congratulations!

Participate in this contest and win next month

Street Smart

by Joseph L Jorden
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Send in your Desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.